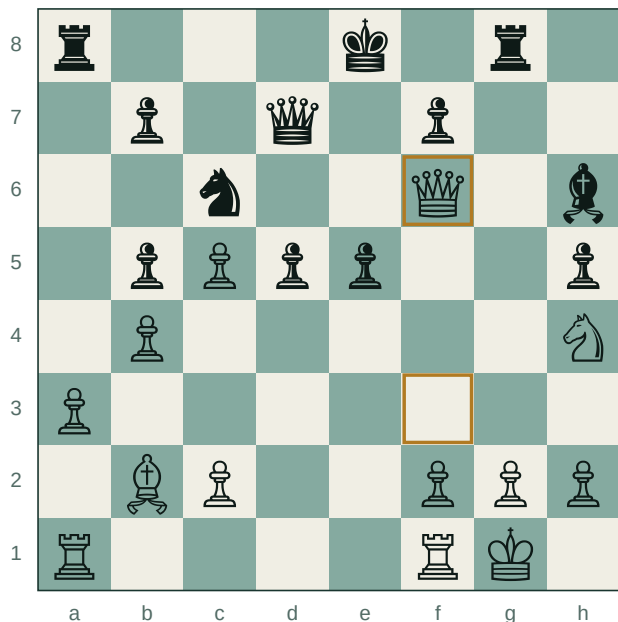


Interference tactics: Black, move 16

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 16.Qxf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16...Bg5 17. Qf3 Bxh4

16...Bg5 The bishop moves from h6 to g5. From g5 it attacks queen on f6 and knight on h4. Recorded reply: **17.Qf3**.

17...Bxh4 The bishop captures the knight on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.